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City of Irving — Library Assistant (Part-Time) — Supplemental Answers

1. Please describe any prior library experience. If none, enter N/A.

I have not held a paid position inside a public library, so I want to be precise about what I have done instead, because a good deal of it is this work in another setting.

In my current role I oversee a physical archive of printed materials for Young Americans for Liberty. That means taking in what arrives, sorting and routing it, processing items, shelving them where they belong, and keeping several years of accumulated material orderly enough that anyone can retrieve from it. When the collection outgrew what anyone could hold in their head, I built a searchable catalog and the database behind it so staff could find things themselves rather than asking me.

Before that, as a student registrar at Chapman University's Fowler School of Law, I staffed the service window. I was the first person students spoke to, which meant answering questions, registering and verifying records, explaining procedures, and referring people on when the answer was not mine to give. I processed and approved over five hundred transcripts, exam records and bar documents in PeopleSoft, where a misfiled record had real consequences for someone.

At the University of Austin I handled intake and documentation of library donations, including a complete Harvard Classics set, and served as the on-site contact for visitor tours of the campus library.

Separately, I founded the Free Knowledge Library, an archive that catalogs political literature, where I designed the classification scheme and built the catalog. I have begun the American Library Association's Library Support Staff Certification and start a Library and Information Services certificate at Central Community College in the spring.

Do not enter N/A here. This is the only one of these postings with a stated experience minimum, and the word it uses is "related", not "library".

2. Part-time employees are not scheduled to work more than 1,000 hours per calendar year. Do you accept this condition?

Yes.

3. Are you able to work day, evening and weekend hours as needed?

Yes.

4. Please provide the days and hours you are available, Sunday through Saturday.

Fill this in yourself with real availability. A suggested shape, assuming you keep your current full-time job while starting out:

Sunday: open availability. Monday through Friday: evenings from 5:00 pm. Saturday: open availability.

If you would be relocating and leaving your current role, say open availability across all seven days, which is a materially stronger answer.

The posting says this is informational and not a schedule request, but it is read as a signal of how much you can actually cover.